


# New York can't build universal child care on poverty wages.

The State is expanding child care faster than ever. The providers who make it possible earn less than 96% of New York workers, and they are leaving the field. Our ask: fund the workforce and fund the families in the 2027 budget.

## $1.8B

### A wage scale for child care workers

Fund the CUNY-PDI / Workforce Collaborative scale (role, credentials, experience; parity with K-12) for every provider, in centers and homes, without raising what families pay or interfering with collective bargaining.

## $1.04B

### CCAP for every eligible family

$400M statewide plus $640M for New York City in recurring funding, so no eligible family is waitlisted or turned away, and providers get fair, reliable income.

## The need

**$37,675**
median child care educator pay; less than 96% of NY jobs

**$6.01**
median hourly take-home for NYC home-based providers

**57%**
of NY programs short-staffed; 16,000+ kids unserved

- Family child care capacity fell **28%** from 2019 to 2024; 60% of census tracts are child care deserts.
- In May 2026, **31 counties and NYC** had stopped enrolling eligible families in CCAP for lack of funds. NYC's waitlist hit ~30,000 children.
- The FY27 budget added $1.2B for CCAP but nothing for wages.

## The principles from NYCAT

1. A statewide wage scale and career ladder, indexed to cost of living.
2. Pay subsidies and CCAP rates based on the true cost of care.
3. Worker voice: sectoral bargaining, a wage board, labor peace.
4. A phase-in backed by dedicated progressive revenue.

## What the wage scale means

| PROVIDER | NOW | SCALE |
|---|---|---|
| NYC family child care, HS diploma, 21 yrs | $33,280 | **$79,184** |
| NYC teacher, associate degree, 3 yrs | $40,000 | **$69,836** |
| Buffalo family child care, HS diploma, 11 yrs | $33,280 | **$53,792** |
| Rochester center director, BA + credential, 6 yrs | $52,000 | **$76,022** |

## New York can pay for it

The Fiscal Policy Institute shows a progressive package (a small payroll tax, a corporate surcharge, and a 1% NYC tax on income over $1M) raises about **$8B a year**, enough for statewide universal care with providers earning $50,000 to $60,000.

**Will you champion these demands?** Tell leadership and the Governor you support $1.8B for the wage scale and $1.04B for CCAP in the 2027 budget, and join POP's Child Care Champions.

Sources: Empire State Campaign for Child Care, 2027 Budget Priorities (Oct 2026); Schuyler Center, NYS DOL data (2025); L. Melodia, Center for NYC Affairs, budget testimony (Feb 2026); Day Care Council of NY (Dec 2025); OCFS data; NYS Comptroller (Feb 2025); New York Focus (June 2026); Chalkbeat (Oct 2026); CUNY-PDI wage scale scenarios; Fiscal Policy Institute (Dec 2025).

PROVIDERS ORGANIZED FOR POWER · the action lab · Empire State Campaign for Child Care · UFT · Citizen Action · New York Communities for Change · AQE Alliance for Quality Education · ECE On The Move · Los Deditos · ILR Worker Institute

**popny.org/pay**
Pay Our Providers is a campaign of Providers Organized for Power (POP).

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